



Department of Economics
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December 18, 2025

Hiring Committee
General Medicine

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Economist position at General Medicine. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns. I find a hump shaped relationship for returns and characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to frame research strategies and design modeling approaches, execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro data sets, and translate results into clear and rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly interested in General Medicine because of its focus on rigorous empirical analysis to inform health care decision making across providers, payers, and policy institutions. Much of the firm's work involves analyzing complex administrative and claims data to evaluate utilization patterns, treatment intensity, and cost drivers across health systems. These questions require careful statistical analysis, an understanding of selection and incentives, and clear interpretation of causal evidence. My training has emphasized exactly these skills. I routinely work with large observational data sets, assess identification assumptions, and evaluate whether estimated relationships reflect persistent structure or confounding. This background positions me well to contribute to work on provider performance, payment design, and policy evaluation at General Medicine.

I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to live and work in the firm's location and to engage fully in the in person research environment that General Medicine expects. I am comfortable working on site according to the firm's schedule and value the collaboration that comes from regular in person interaction. I am also drawn to the prospect of a three year role, which would allow me to deepen my applied research skills while continuing to develop my broader research agenda in a setting where careful empirical analysis directly informs health care policy and operational decisions.

I believe I would be a strong fit at General Medicine because:

1. My experience with applied econometrics and large scale data analysis aligns with the firm's work on health care utilization and cost outcomes.
2. My research on heterogeneity prepares me to analyze variation in patient and provider behavior across settings.
3. I bring strong communication skills and a collaborative approach that supports effective interaction with multidisciplinary teams and external stakeholders.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my quantitative training, modeling experience, and interest in applied research to General Medicine. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards